

Little Red Riding Hood

An abridged public-domain fairy tale



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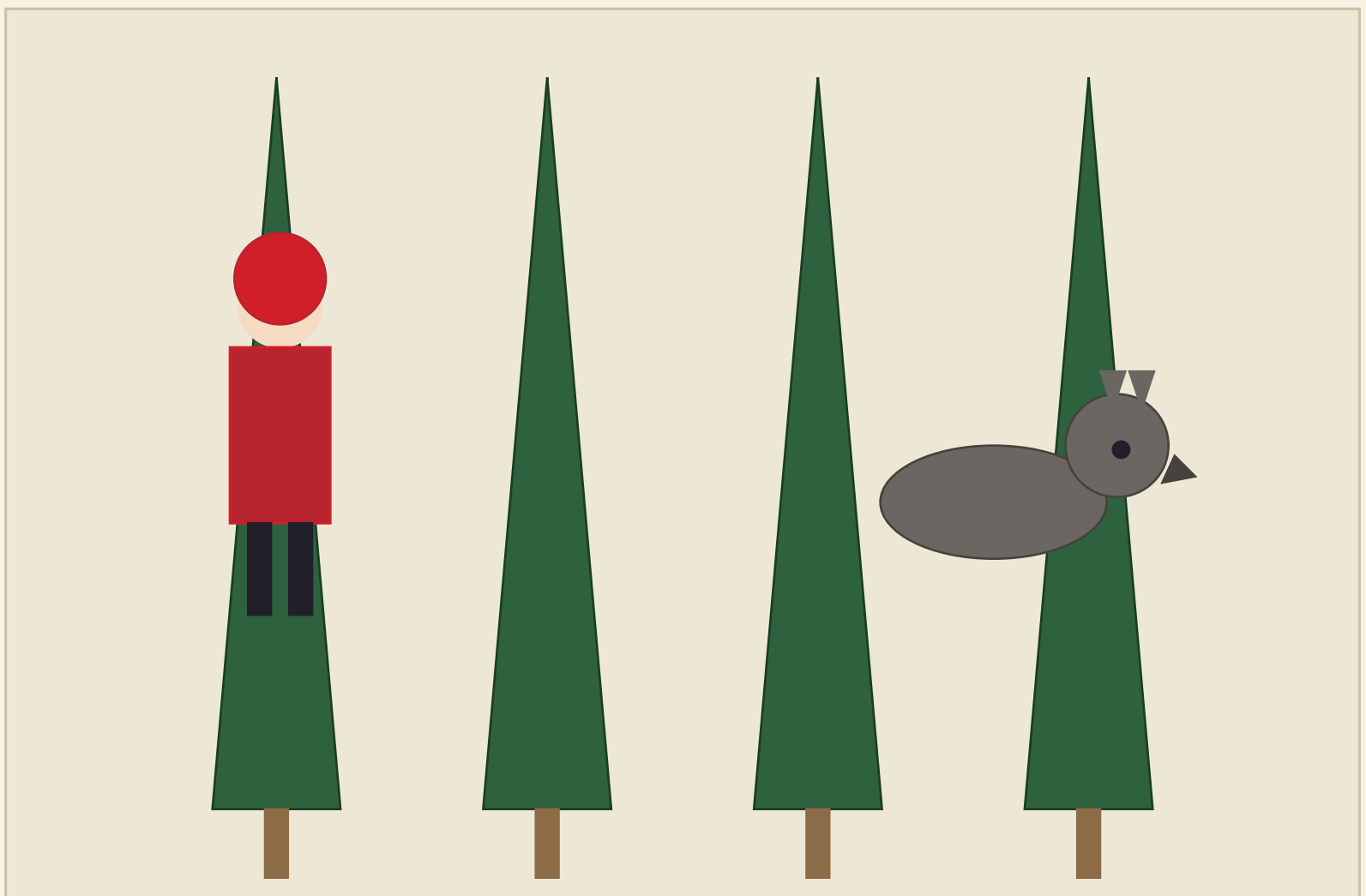
1. Through the woods

Once upon a time there was a sweet little girl whom everyone loved. Her grandmother loved her most of all, and made her a little red riding hood. One day her mother said, "Take this cake and bottle of wine to your grandmother, who is ill. Go quietly and do not leave the path." Little Red Riding Hood promised to obey, put on her red hood, took her basket, and set out through the wood.



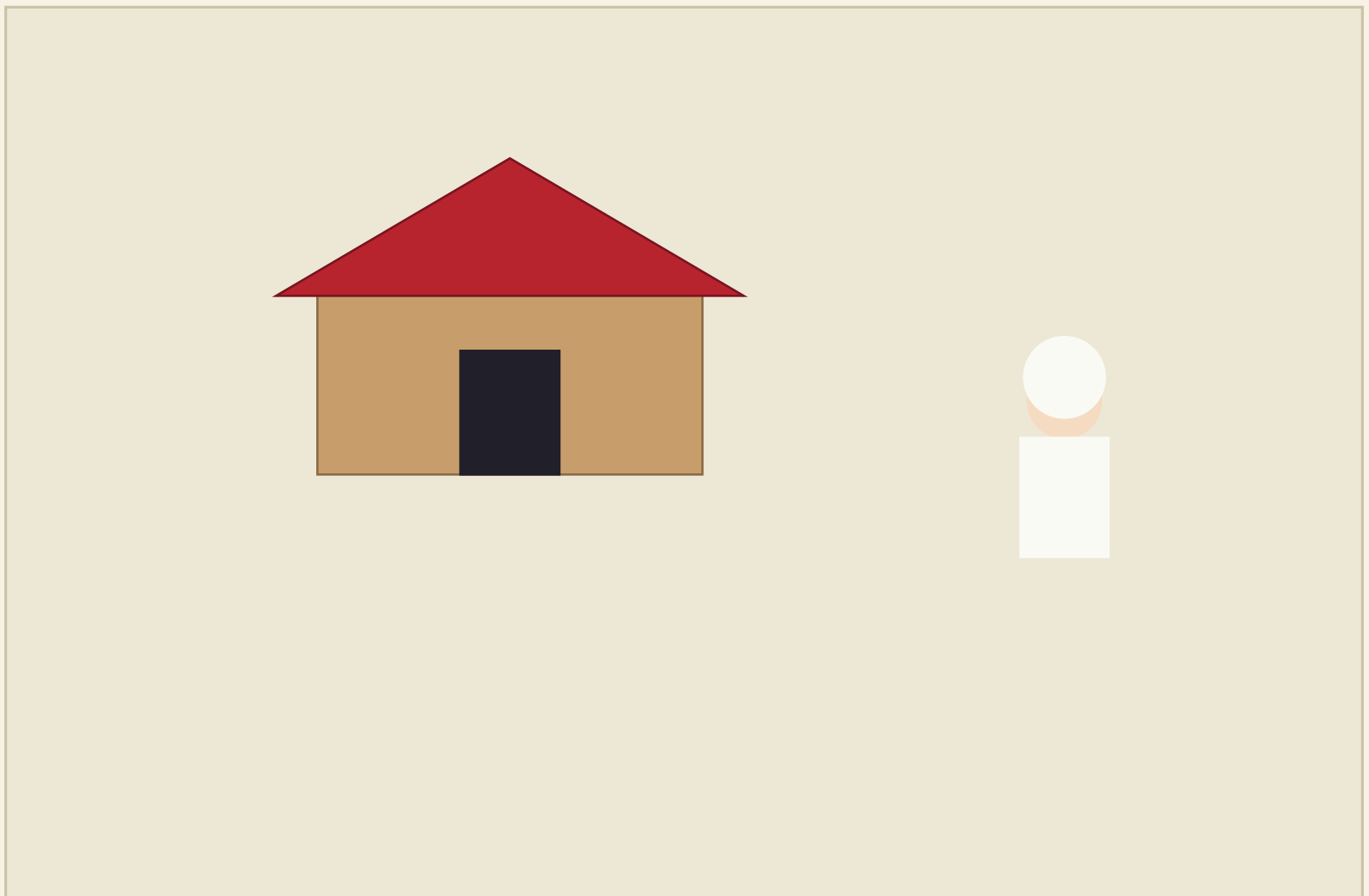
2. The wolf on the path

She had not gone far when a wolf met her. He wished her good day, and asked whither she was going. The child told him she was taking cake and wine to her grandmother. The wolf thought, "What a tender young creature ? what a nice plump mouthful." But he walked beside her and said, "Look at the pretty flowers. Why do you not look round?" Little Red Riding Hood raised her eyes, and when she saw the sunbeams dancing through the trees, she left the path to pick a nosegay for her grandmother.



3. At grandmother's door

While Little Red Riding Hood gathered flowers, the wolf ran straight to the grandmother's house and knocked. "Who is there?" "Little Red Riding Hood, with cake and wine." "Lift the latch," said the grandmother. The wolf sprang in, swallowed the poor old woman, put on her nightcap, and lay down in her bed with the curtains drawn. When the child came to the cottage she was surprised to find the door unlatched, and everything seemed strange.



4. "What big eyes you have!"

"Good morning, Grandmother," she said, but received no answer. She drew the curtains, and there lay the grandmother with her cap pulled far over her face, looking very strange. "Oh, Grandmother, what big ears you have!" "The better to hear you with." "What big eyes you have!" "The better to see you with." "What large hands you have!" "The better to hug you with." "But, Grandmother, what a terrible big mouth you have!" "The better to eat you with!" And scarcely had the wolf said this when he sprang out of bed and swallowed up Little Red Riding Hood.

